

**MINUTES OF PROCEEDINGS AT MEETING OF THE
MUNICIPAL DISTRICT OF NEWCASTLE WEST HELD IN
ÁRAS WILLIAM SMITH OBRIEN, NEWCASTLE WEST,
CO. LIMERICK, ON WEDNESDAY, 2ND APRIL, 2025, AT
10AM.**

PRESENT IN THE CHAIR:

Councillor L. Galvin, Cathaoirleach.

MEMBERS PRESENT:

Councillors Collins, Foley, Ruddell, Scanlan and Sheahan.

OFFICIALS IN ATTENDANCE:

Director, Rural, Culture, Community and Tourism Development (Mr. S. Duclot), Meetings Administrator, Newcastle West (Ms. H. Supple), Senior Executive Engineer, Newcastle West Municipal District (Mr. J. Sheehan), Executive Engineer, Roads (Mr. P. Vallely), Senior Executive Engineer, Roads, Traffic and Cleansing (Mr. S. O'Reilly), Executive Engineer, Roads, Traffic and Cleansing (Mr. M. Clarke), Clerical Officer, Newcastle West (Ms. A. Lenihan).

Mr. Seán Corcoran, Managing Director, and Mr. Brian Considine, Project Manager, Electric Skyline Limited.

APOLOGIES:

Councillor Collins.

At the outset of the Meeting, the Cathaoirleach and Members extended their condolences and sympathy to Councillor Collins, his wife and family, and the O'Connor family on the passing of Mr. Mortimer O'Connor, father in law of Councillor Collins.

The Members welcomed the Director to the District and thanked everyone in attendance to the April Meeting of the District.

1. Adoption of Minutes

- (a) Circulated, copy of draft Minutes of Meeting of Municipal District of Newcastle West, held on 5th March, 2025.

Proposed by: Councillor Foley
Seconded by: Councillor Scanlan
And Resolved:

"That, the draft Minutes, as circulated, be taken as read and adopted and signed".

2. Declaration of Interest.

The Meetings Administrator stated that, in line with Part 15 of the Local Government Act, 2001, as amended, and the Code of Conduct, she was inviting those present to notify the Cathaoirleach of any declaration of interest in any item due for discussion at the Meeting. No such interests were declared.

3. Transportation and Mobility Directorate

To Receive Presentation from Electric Skyline Limited

The Cathaoirleach welcomed Mr. Seán Corcoran, Managing Director, and Mr. Brian Considine, Project Manager, Electric Skyline Limited to the Meeting.

Mr Corcoran addressed the Meeting and outlined the background to the company which was formed in 2007. He stated that the company took over from Enerveo who ceased operations in maintenance contracts in Limerick in July 2024 and that the company now maintain a total of 220,000 street lights in 14 Local Authorities in the country. He stated that Electric Skyline Limited maintenance contract commenced on 1st November, 2024 and for the period July 2024 to November 2024 reactive maintenance only was carried out by Electric Skyline Limited. Mr. Corcoran gave an overview on staffing in the company and stated that a depot is located in Newcastle West to service the Limerick contract.

Mr. Corcoran gave statistics on the current status of public lights in Limerick City and County Council in November 2024. He stated that the total number of public lights to be maintained by Limerick City and County Council is 23,834 and the total number of lights in the Newcastle West District is 2,945. He made reference to the percentage of faults and open cases as at November 2024.

He outlined to the Members the significant challenges encountered by the company since taking on the public lighting maintenance contract in November 2024 including snow, storms and mandatory ESB Network stand down periods, training and hiring staff, and the number of faults as at November 2024. Mr. Corcoran outlined to the Members the current status of public lighting in Limerick today which is now 99.18% fault free and that the Newcastle West District is 99.35% fault free.

He made reference to the status of outstanding faults and to the various issues encountered in resolving these faults including access issues, interfaces required, ESB issues, no supply, column issues and materials required but however is working with the relevant stakeholders in resolving these matters.

The Members thanked Mr. Corcoran for the presentation and acknowledged the huge improvement in public lighting in Limerick and in the Newcastle West District. The Members referred to a number of matters including a direct contact number for the Members to log public lights out of order, length of time taken to get lights repaired, night patrols, and

provision of regular updates to the Members. The Members gave an update to Mr. Corcoran on the location of a number of lights which are currently out of order in the District.

In replying to matters raised by the Members, Mr. Corcoran referred to issues associated with decorative lighting and that a survey is currently being carried out on decorative lighting. He stated that the timeframe for getting public lights fixed is ten working days. In response to a query raised by the Members on a contact number for the Members to report faults, the Senior Executive Engineer stated that the Members can email the public lighting team who will then send on faults to Electric Skyline Limited.

4. Transportation and Mobility Directorate

To consider Draft Schedule of Works for the Municipal District of Newcastle West.

Circulated, report of Director of Services, dated March 2025, setting out the details of the Draft Schedule of Works for the Municipal District of Newcastle West 2025.

The Members welcomed the report and the funding which was made available for the various projects in the Schedule.

The funding allocated to drainage works on the Hill Road in Abbeyfeale was acknowledged but however the need for resurfacing works and how much more additional funding was allocated for these works was raised. In replying, the Senior Executive Engineer stated that a submission has been made for additional funding and a response is awaited.

The temporary surface on the High Road in Mountcollins was raised and when the final resurfacing works will be carried out on this road. Reference was made to the condition of the Ballagh Road. In response, the Senior Executive Engineer referred to the funding allocated under Active Travel for various projects including the proposal for a Broadford Village Boardwalk to allow safe access over the bridge and that it is anticipated that this project will be put in progress to a Part 8 planning application in September 2025. The funding allocated to Feohanagh Village footpaths under Active Travel was also raised. The design of a footpath from the Kerry Group to the Bruff Line was referred to and in replying, the Senior Executive Engineer stated that the design for the scheme will be carried out in 2025. Currently, the Consultant is being procured on E-Tenders.

The NTA Active Travel schemes for 2025 are at the following locations:

- (a) Broadford Village Boardwalk
- (b) Feohanagh Village
- (c) Ashford village
- (d) Strand village
- (e) Ballyagran village
- (f) Design of R520 Bruff Line

The Members were satisfied with the spread of schemes to urban centres that had not previously received Active Travel funding.

The current arrangement of work operations at the Roads Depot in Kinard, Glin, was referred to and a query was raised on having this depot available to serve the Glin, Carrickerry and Athea roads areas. The condition of a section of the Gortnagross road was also raised. The increased cost of materials was noted and in replying, the Senior Executive Engineer stated that an application for additional funding has been made due to severe weather conditions and a response is awaited.

The excellent service provided by the suction sweeper and the sourcing of the suction sweeper in the District was acknowledged. However, the provision of a suction sweeper early on a Saturday morning to gain access to places which cannot be met on weekdays was raised.

The Members acknowledged the comprehensive works programme and referred to current staffing levels to carry out the works outlined in the Schedule. In replying, the Senior Executive Engineer stated that a number of business cases have been submitted for outdoor staff and following discussion, it was agreed that the Director would follow up on this matter with the Human Resources Department.

Following discussion, the Members unanimously adopted the Schedule of Works 2025 for the Municipal District of Newcastle West.

5. General Municipal Allocation (GMA)

No monies were allocated under General Municipal Allocation at the April Meeting.

QUESTIONS

Replies to the following Questions on the Agenda were circulated to all Members prior to the Meeting and the Questions were therefore taken as having been dealt with.

6. Question submitted by Councillor L. Galvin

I will ask at the next Meeting for the total amount of money allocated to Abbeyfeale Town Park for 2023 and 2024, how much of this money has been spent and an outline of the plans in place for how the remainder of this money will be spent.

REPLY:

Limerick City and County Council provide maintenance for the playground in the Town Park and also arrange insurance cover for the playground. A successful application was made by the Council to the Department of Community Rural and Community Development (DRCD) under the Community Recognition Fund in 2024.

The Environment and Climate Action Department have prepared tender documents to upgrade the playground which should be completed in 2025. The funding allocated under

the Community Recognition Fund (€50,000) and the GMA (€51,500) will result in a significant upgrade to the playground facilities.

7. Question submitted by Councillor L. Galvin

I will ask at the next Meeting for a detailed update/report on the Ray's housing estate in Mountcollins, to include sewerage, water, lighting and road surface.

REPLY:

Councillor Galvin in response to your question a contractor has been appointed to install the 150m of watermain to the estate along with the installation of a new fire hydrant and new connections to each property within the estate. We are awaiting a start date from the contractor to commence on site and will update when works commence.

8. Question submitted by Councillor L. Galvin

I will ask at the next Meeting for a detailed report/update of all Part 8 planning applications for housing in this District.

REPLY:

There are currently two Part 8 live Planning Applications for residential use in the Newcastle West District. Please see table below for Planning description and progress of each application.

Part 8 Reference	Planning Description	Progress
PT8LL54	4 no. 2 storey residential units at Radharc an Ghleanna, Mountcollins – 2 no. 3 bedroom and 2 no. 2 bedroom houses.	At Stage 3 of approval process with Dept. of Housing. Funding dependant, project will go to tender in Qtr.3/Qtr. 4 of 2025.
22/8020	The proposed development will be completed in two phases and will consist of: (a) Phase 1: The provision of 21 no. residential units comprised of two storey and three storey dormer buildings, with a unit mix comprised of 6 no. 1 Bed units, 6 no. 2 Bed units, 6 no. 3 Bed units, 3 no. 4 Bed units: (b) Phase 2: The provision of 10 no. residential units comprised of single storey and two storey buildings, with a unit mix	The proposed development at Sycamore Crescent for 31 units has been refused a foul sewer connection by Uisce Eireann due to lack of capacity. A pre-connection enquiry was submitted to Uisce Eireann prior to lodging the part 8 application and approved. On completion of the treatment plant upgrade, this development will be recommenced. Uisce Eireann have given an approximate timeline for the upgrade works to be completed within the next seven years.

	comprised of 4 no. 1 Bed units, 6 no. 2 Bed units; (c) New road running north-west connecting the existing Sycamore Crescent estate with the proposed development, then returning around from the north to run southeast to service proposed units to the rear, including all associated footpaths and 37 no. car parking spaces; (d) Hard landscaping including; bin stores, privacy strip to front gardens, rear garden walls, bicycle stands, installation of street lighting; (e) New public open space including soft landscaping, tree planting, street furniture, street lighting, footpaths; (f) Soft landscaping including planting and trees throughout; (g) Construction of and / or remedial works to boundaries with adjacent sites; (h) Construction of new water main, new foul and storm sewers to connect into existing drainage system, and surface water drainage systems including Suds measures; (i) Connection to public utilities; (j) All associated site works	
218012	(phase 1)the provision of 11 no. residential units, consisting of 2 no. 1 bed units, 1 no. 4 bed unit, 6 no. 2 bed units, 2 no. 3 bed units, (phase 2)the provision of 7 no. residential units, consisting of 5 no. 1 bed units, 2 no. 2 bed units, hard landscaping including new footpaths, new entranceways, boundary treatments and boundary walls, upgrading of foul sewers and surface water drainage and all associated site works at Cluain Dara Broadford Co. Limerick	Currently on-site.
228013	the construction of 10 no. housing units in addition to ancillary site	Tenders under view. Stage 4 application for funding to be made.

	works comprising of a new vehicular junction (with the R521), an access road, services, footpaths, parking, boundary treatment and landscaping units at O'Connor Park Reerasta North Ardagh, Co. Limerick	
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9. Question submitted by Councillor J. Scanlan

I will ask at the next Meeting what effect in terms of delivery is the constrained wastewater utility infrastructure in Newcastle West town likely to have on our much anticipated Social Housing project at Sycamore Crescent, Gortboy, Newcastle West i.e. when is it expected to (a) commence and (b) complete.

REPLY:

To recap, Limerick City and County Council received correspondence from Uisce Éireann outlining connection feasibility in November 2020. Following receipt of the Part 8 approval, correspondence was issued to Uisce Éireann to regenerate the Connection and Development Service offer and establish connection (May 2024). A number of emails were issued to Uisce Éireann and as Limerick City and County Council were not receiving positive feedback, Limerick City and County Council requested that the LGMA get involved. In July 2024, a number of minor Uisce Éireann queries in relation to the connection were answered by Limerick City and County Council. A number of emails were issued by Limerick City and County Council to Uisce Éireann requesting an update between July and October 2024 without response. Limerick City and County Council were contacted by the LGMA in December 2024 stating that a decision was about to be made and it would be a positive outcome, however, some changes were required which would be designed out. No decision was received.

Following an online meeting with Uisce Éireann on 26th February 2025, we were advised by Uisce Éireann that a decision was imminent, however it did not appear positive. On 26th February 2025, Limerick City and County Council received correspondence from Uisce Éireann stating that a connection could not be progressed as capacity was unavailable. Uisce Éireann further stated that capital works are planned but are several years away. Therefore, the proposed Sycamore Crescent housing development is now on hold until Uisce Éireann provide a connection.

Councillor Scanlan expressed dissatisfaction at the response received and that the development of housing is being held up in the District due to insufficient capacity in the treatment plant.

10. Question submitted by Councillor J. Scanlan

I will ask at the next Meeting (a) when safety measures will be put in place at Ashford School and (b) when footpath extensions to the speed limit on each side of the village will be delivered.

REPLY: There is no budget assigned to carry out safety works in 2025, it will be assessed for safety measures to be delivered in 2026. The NTA scheme in the village is expected to be delivered during Q3 of 2025.

11. Question submitted by Councillor J. Scanlan

I will ask at the next Meeting that the verge of the local road opposite Castlemahon Church be cleaned and made safe.

REPLY: Limerick City and County Council will carry out these works within the next month.

NOTICES OF MOTION

12. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor L. Galvin

I will move at the next Meeting that the parking bye-laws be extended east of Abbeyfeale to beyond "Greyhound and Pet World".

The Motion was seconded by Councillor Foley.

REPLY: Limerick City and County Council have no objection to the extension of the bye laws, however can it be confirmed the reason is to facilitate the commercial businesses.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Galvin requested that the bye-laws be extended up to and including the Greyhound and Pet World premises. Following a brief discussion, it was agreed that the bye-laws should extend the distance required under the Notice of Motion. The intention is to provide a drawing for the Members approval as soon as possible.

13. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor L. Galvin

I will move at the next Meeting that this Council carry out works at the bridge/stream at the old Post Office, Ballaugh V42TR66 to prevent flooding and damage to the public road and other property.

The Motion was seconded by Councillor Sheahan.

REPLY: We will commit to undertake an inspection of this structure and determine what works if any are required. Any works to be carried out will be dependent on funding and approvals from the Department and the relevant statutory bodies.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Galvin referred to the condition of the public road and requested that works be carried out to the bridge to prevent flooding and subsequent damage. In replying, the Executive Engineer stated that the Council will continue to monitor the area more frequently to assess what works if any are required.

14. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor J. Scanlan

I will move at the next Meeting that Skyline be requested to present to our Municipal Council.

The Motion was seconded by Councillor Galvin.

REPLY: Skyline will be in attendance at the April meeting.

15. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor J. Scanlan

I will move at the next Meeting that this Municipal Council call on the Taoiseach and Minister for Housing to immediately increase the recently announced funding allocation towards the purchase of properties for Tenants-in-Situ here in Newcastle West.

The Motion was seconded by Councillor Ruddle.

REPLY: The DHLGH have not yet issued the Circular in relation to the 2025 funding allocation for housing acquisitions in Limerick. Once we receive notification, we will keep Elected Members informed of the budget allocation and any specific conditions associated with it.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Scanlan referred to the insufficient level of funding allocated at national level for the purchase of properties for tenants in situ and following discussion by the Members with regard to the importance of the scheme and funding, it was agreed that the Meetings Administrator would forward this Notice of Motion to the Taoiseach and the Minister for Housing, Local Government and Heritage.

16. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor T. Ruddle

I will move at the next Meeting that Limerick City and County Council clean up rubbish and clean up the basketball court at Sharwood estate, Newcastle West. I suggest this should be done on a regular basis.

The Motion was seconded by Councillor Scanlan.

REPLY:

Members of Sharwood Estate conduct a litter pick twice a year in association with Community Sustainment Officer. Community Sustainment are currently supplying litter pickers to the residents for the next litter picking operation organised for pre- Easter 2025. Limerick City and County Council will remove the bags of litter from this operation.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Ruddle referred to littering at Sharwood Estate, Newcastle West and requested that the Council remove the rubbish and carry out a clean up of the estate. In replying, the Senior Executive Engineer stated that clean ups are carried out in the estate and that a Meeting with Estate Management is to take place in Sharwood Estate today with regard to this matter. The Senior Executive Engineer agreed to follow up on a request for CCTV in the estate to alleviate the littering issue.

17. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor T. Ruddle

I will move at the next Meeting that Limerick City and County Council affix the loose stones in the Square, Newcastle West. These can be dangerous.

The Motion was seconded by Councillor Galvin.

REPLY: Limerick City and County Council will repair the loose concrete slabs as part of the routine maintenance contract. This is an ongoing measure for the Council throughout the year.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Ruddle requested that any loose stones be fixed in The Square, Newcastle West. In replying, the Senior Executive Engineer stated he is endeavouring to get a funding allocation to improve The Square in Newcastle West. He stated that funding is being made available to improve the infrastructure in The Square in Newcastle West. Details of the proposed scheme will be given at future Municipal District Meetings once agreed with the relevant Directorate.

The following items were also raised.

An update was sought on the progression of the Part 8 for the new burial ground in Abbeyfeale.

An update was also sought on the lands at the rear of the old bank being made available for car parking as part of the Abbeyfeale Traffic Management Plan. It was agreed that the Director would follow up on these matters with the relevant Directorates.

A request was received from the Dromcollogher26 Cinema Commemoration Committee to attend a Meeting of the District to highlight the Dromcollogher Cinema Disaster of 1926 commemorative event. The Members agreed to the attendance of a delegation at the May Meeting of the District.

A brief discussion took place on Approved Housing Bodies and in particular Cluid Housing Association. Following discussion, it was agreed that the Meetings Administrator would invite a representative of Clúid Housing Association to the next Meeting of the District.

The Members wished to congratulate the Limerick Senior Football Team and Management on their recent winning of the Division 4 Senior Football League.

It was agreed to hold the April Meeting of the District on Wednesday, 7th May, 2025, at 10.00 a.m., at Áras William Smith OBrien.

This concluded the Meeting.

Signed:

Cathaoirleach

Dated: